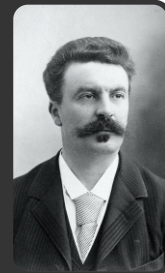


3. THE NECKLACE

BY GUY DE MAUPASSANT

August 5, 1850 – July 6, 1893

"The Necklace" by Guy de Maupassant tells the story of Mathilde Loisel, a woman dissatisfied with her modest life who borrows a diamond necklace to attend a luxurious ball. After losing the necklace, she works for ten years to repay the debt, only to discover that the necklace was a fake. The story explores themes of vanity, materialism, and the consequences of pursuing status, delivering a powerful message about the fleeting nature of wealth and the cost of pride.



EXERCISE 1- MATCH THE FOLLOWING (ANSWERS)

No.	COLUMN A	COLUMN B
1.	elite	Upper class / Aristocracy
2.	fancy	Attractive / Exquisite in structure or decoration
3.	thrilled	Excited
4.	embarrassed	Ashamed / Feeling awkward
5.	retrace	Retract / Move back on the same path
6.	horrified	Frightened / Terrified
7.	scrub	Clean / Rub to clean something
8.	shabby	Old / In poor condition
9.	strolling	Walking in leisurely manner
10.	clasp	Grip / Grab tightly

EXERCISE 2- MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. _____ was working in education.

- ☐ A Mathilde
 ☐ B Loisel
 ☐ C Mansion
 ☐ D Forester

2. Mathilde belonged to a/an _____ family.

- ☐ A rich
 ☐ B poor
 ☐ C middle class
 ☐ D elite

3. Loisel gave Mathilde four hundred francs to _____.

- ☐ A buy outfits
 ☐ B go to theatre
 ☐ C buy jewellery
 ☐ D help her friend

4. Mathilde seemed happiest when she

- ☐ A received the invitation.
 ☐ B danced in the party
 ☐ C bought a new dress
 ☐ D borrowed the necklace

5. The main theme of 'The Necklace' is:

- A** We suffer for our vanities **B** It is unwise to borrow things
C Parties can lead to trouble **D** Friends should be honest with each other

6. When she borrowed the necklace, Mme. Loisel spent the whole evening

- A** talking with her husband **B** watching rich people
C wishing she had not come **D** dancing with many men

7. In order to pay the necklace, M. Loisel does all of the following except:

- A** contribute his entire inheritance **B** make deals with loan swindlers
C borrowing money from the bank **D** paying his house loan

8. Throughout the story, Mme. Loisel values:

- A** love **B** appearances
C knowledge **D** wisdom

9. When Mathilde had to return the Necklace, she was looking as:

- A** rich **B** proud
C peasant **D** miser

10. Mathilde bought another Necklace for _____ francs.

- A** sixty **B** fifty
C thirty six **D** fifty six

EXERCISE 1- MATCH THE FOLLOWING (ANSWERS)

No.	STATEMENT	ANSWER
1.	At first, Mathilde demanded a diamond necklace from her husband.	×
2.	Mathilde wept after returning from her friend's home.	×
3.	Poverty ruined Mathilde's life and looks.	✓
4.	The story of 'The Necklace' tells about greed and hope.	✓
5.	The idiom 'burst into tears' means weep intensely.	✓
6.	Sous and francs are the words that indicate currency.	✓
7.	After seven days, they decided to replace the diamond necklace.	✓
8.	In the end of the story, the same diamond necklace was returned.	×

EXERCISE 1- POST READING

1. Why did M. Loisel expect his wife to be pleased to receive the invitation?

Mathilde was the wife of Mr. Loisel, whose face always bore witness to her grievances and agony. She belonged to the middle-class family and did not have a good collection of dresses and jewelry. She always dreamt of being rich and was fond of attending grand parties. When Mr. Loisel gave her the invitation to grand party at Ministerial mansion, he expected his wife to be pleased as she'd never had such a chance before. However, she tossed the invitation aside lamenting that middle class clerks cannot attend such lavish events.

2. What was Mme. Loisel's reaction on reading the invitation?

She got frustrated after looking at the invitation as her monetary resources were scarce. She burst into tears, because she did not have a fancy dress to wear at the party. Without all such arrangement, she went into inferiority complex and the invitation card, instead of pleasing saddened her heart bitterly.

3. How was the life of Mme. Loisel before the loss of the necklace?

Before losing the necklace, Mme. Loisel was a pretty, charming and elegant lady who seemed young and attractive. She was not rich but had a loving and caring husband and enough money to live a happy life. However, she always dreamt of being rich and remained unsatisfied with her average lifestyle.

4. What efforts were made to find Mme. Forestier's necklace?

The loss of necklace was a sudden calamity. After Mme. Forestier's necklace was lost, Mme. Loisel with her husband searched everywhere in the apartment but found nothing. Her husband also retraced the steps and came back after several hours with no luck in finding the necklace. After a week passed, they lost all their hopes.

5. Describe in your own words, how Loisel's life changed after they had paid for the new necklace.

Mr. Loisel and his wife were living a peaceful life despite monetary deprivations. As they lost the necklace, they felt a calamity had fallen upon them. Their usual life pattern was bitterly shaken and they had to go through an unimaginable state of poverty. In order to buy a new diamond necklace, Mr. Loisel utilized all his inherited money, borrowed money from other people and took loan from the money lender at high interest. After that, they lead a poverty-stricken life in order to repay the borrowed amount. They both lived in a small and cheap apartment and worked hard. Mme. Loisel cooked and did all the household chores and dressed like a peasant. She bargained with every vendor to save pennies. Mr. Loisel worked day and night in double shifts and this continued for ten years until all the debts and interest were paid.

6. What was Mme. Forestier's reaction on seeing Mme. Loisel, before she figured out who she was?

One day, Mathilde met Mme. Forestier while strolling in the park. Mathilde greeted her by calling out her nickname 'Jeanne' but Mme. Forestier did not seem to recognize her at all. She was surprised when Mathilde introduced herself and cried out asking that what had happened to her.

7. How did Mr. and Mme. Loisel replace the necklace?

In order to cope with the dire situation, they thought over many options. They needed a handsome amount in cash so they borrowed the money and searched the similar looking necklace. They bought it for thirty-six thousand francs and returned it to Mme. Forestier in place of the borrowed one who did not notice the replacement of the jewelry.

8. What was Mme. Forestier's reaction when the necklace was returned?

Mme. Forestier behaved rudely when the necklace was returned. She did not open the box to confirm the jewelry but let Mme. Loisel feel that she should have returned it earlier, in case she needed to wear it.

9. How did Mr. Loisel contribute to the cost of the new necklace?

The price of the new jewelry was forty-thousand francs which was bargained down to thirty-six thousand francs. Mr. Loisel had eighteen thousand francs inherited from his father. He gave all the amount to Mathilde for purchasing the new necklace. He borrowed the rest of the amount from his friends and money lenders on a very high interest rate. In this way, he sacrificed all what he had to compensate for his wife's mistake.

10. How had Mme. Loisel's sacrifices been in vain?

There came to a lot of payment on Mr. and Mme. Loisel as they bought the new necklace. It was a huge number of debts and loan to be paid. This changing phase of life brought a revolution in their lifestyle, living standards, and habits. They simply thought of liquidating the debts and forgot all about their comforts and luxuries. This nurtured a kind of wisdom in them but snatched away their youthful appearance and liveliness. They lead a life full of poverty and hardships for ten years. Finally, when Mathilde told Mme. Forestier about the jewelry being replaced by another similar looking diamond necklace, she got to know that the original one was fake worth five hundred francs. In this way, her ten hard-working years had been in vain.